

UNIT 9 / Everyday situations

Mission: ask for help

Your goal: Handle a small everyday problem with polite requests.

01 Learn the idea

Können Sie mir helfen? is a useful polite request when something goes wrong. Mir means to me in this expression. Explain one concrete problem: Ich finde meine Tasche nicht or Mein Handy funktioniert nicht. A clear short statement lets the other person ask the right follow-up question.

Use Entschuldigung to get attention politely and Danke für Ihre Hilfe to finish. Describe a missing item with a colour or location from earlier lessons. If you miss a question, ask for repetition. This review combines clothes, locations and requests in a small lost-property scenario.

Words and phrases

German	English
Können Sie mir helfen?	Can you help me?
Ich finde meine Tasche nicht.	I cannot find my bag.
Sie ist schwarz.	It is black.
Entschuldigung!	Excuse me!
Danke für Ihre Hilfe.	Thank you for your help.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Entschuldigung! Ich finde meine Tasche nicht.

Excuse me! I cannot find my bag.

Staff

Welche Farbe hat sie?

What colour is it?

Mia

Sie ist schwarz.

It is black.

Staff

Hier ist eine schwarze Tasche.

Here is a black bag.

Your real-life mission

Role-play asking for help with a missing bag. Give its colour, say where you last had it and thank the helper.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Können Sie mir helfen?” mean?

- A. I cannot find my bag.
- B. It is black.
- C. Can you help me?

2. What does “Ich finde meine Tasche nicht.” mean?

- A. I cannot find my bag.
- B. It is black.
- C. Excuse me!

3. What does “Sie ist schwarz.” mean?

- A. Excuse me!
- B. It is black.
- C. Thank you for your help.

4. Which phrase politely asks for help?

- A. Können Sie mir helfen?
- B. Wie spät ist es?
- C. Ich habe eine Reservierung.

5. What colour is the missing bag?

- A. White
- B. Black
- C. Blue

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - Can you help me?

“Können Sie mir helfen?” means “Can you help me?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - I cannot find my bag.

“Ich finde meine Tasche nicht.” means “I cannot find my bag.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - It is black.

“Sie ist schwarz.” means “It is black.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. A - Können Sie mir helfen?

Können Sie mir helfen? directly asks whether the person can help you.

5. B - Black

Mia describes it as schwarz.

One possible mission response

Entschuldigung! Können Sie mir helfen? Ich finde meine Tasche nicht. Sie ist schwarz. Sie war im Café. Danke für Ihre Hilfe.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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